You

Based on this email conversation and my CV, how can I prepare for the Teams call?

Good Afternoon both,

I hope you are well.

I'm writing to formally register my interest in applying for a Labs Demonstrator position for the Fundamentals of Programming and Artificial Intelligence modules in the upcoming first semester of the 2025/26 academic year. I understand this is quite early, but I wanted to express my enthusiasm for these roles well in advance and offer my application.

I was fortunate to serve as a demonstrator for first-year modules in both semesters last year, and thoroughly enjoyed the experience—especially being able to support students and collaborate with faculty. These two particular modules stood out to me during my studies, not only because they were my highest-scoring modules in their respective semesters (100% in Fundamentals of Programming and 93% in AI), but also because I found the content genuinely stimulating and deeply aligned with my long-term interests in software development and AI.

For your reference, I've attached my updated CV which now includes my second-year grades and recent work experience. Highlights include:

- *A part-time position at Bradford Children and Families Trust (BCFT), where I developed an AI-powered document extraction app and delivered a live demo to social care teams.*
- *Hands-on experience in AI through applications like my AI Testing Agent and AI Cover Letter Writer, demonstrating practical use of tools like Gemini and Hugging Face.*
- *Leadership in university group projects, such as building an extracurricular system for university societies and developing a Task Management system for YHROCU in Enterprise Pro.*
- *Certifications in Microsoft Azure AI Fundamentals and a Brad-Attain High Achievement in Research Award for my internship contributions.*

I'm confident that my technical skill set, teaching experience, and passion for these subjects would allow me to make a strong contribution to the delivery of these modules.

Please let me know if there are any other formal application steps I should follow or further details you require.

Warm regards,
Hasan Akhtar

Hi Hasan,
Thanks for your e-mail. Can you let me know your full availability for a Teams call to discuss your interest in the position and relevant experience next week from Monday afternoon through to Thursday please?
Best regards,
Paul

Hi Paul,
I'd be happy to have a Teams call on Monday afternoon. I'm available at around 3 or 4pm on Monday. Alternatively, I'm also available all day on Wednesday and at around 4 or 5 pm on both Tuesday or Thursday.

Let me know which day and time works best for you.

Many Thanks,
Hasan

Wednesday 1000-1030 on Teams?
Best regards,
Paul

Ok that's fine with me. Should I add in the event or will you?
Many thanks,
Hasan Akhtar

I'll send an invite. If you can have a think about why you would like to do the role, what you could bring to it, what your approach in the labs might look like etc. that would be great.

Best regards,
Paul

Copilot

You're in a great position, Hasan—your CV and email already show strong alignment with the Labs Demonstrator role. To make the most of your Teams call with Paul, here's how you can prepare strategically and confidently:

🧠 Reflect on *Why* You Want the Role

Paul specifically asked you to think about this, so be ready to articulate it clearly:

- **Personal motivation**: Share how teaching energizes you and how last year's experience reinforced your passion for mentoring.
- **Module connection**: Emphasize your top marks (100% in Fundamentals of Programming, 93% in AI) and how those modules shaped your interest in software development and AI.
- **Long-term relevance**: Mention how this role complements your career goals in AI and development, especially given your freelance and BCFT experience.

💡 What You Bring to the Role

Frame your strengths in terms of *value to students and staff*:

- **Technical depth**: You've built AI tools (Document Extraction App, AI Cover Letter Writer) and led group projects—highlight how this gives you real-world insight to share.
- **Teaching experience**: You've already supported first-year labs, so you understand common student challenges and how to guide them effectively.
- **Communication & leadership**: From your BCFT demo to your group project leadership, you've shown you can explain complex ideas clearly and collaborate well.

🛠️ Your Approach in the Labs

This is where you can stand out. Think practical and student-focused:

- **Supportive presence**: Describe how you'd foster a welcoming, non-intimidating environment where students feel safe asking questions.
- **Problem-solving mindset**: Share how you'd help students debug code by guiding their thinking rather than giving answers outright.
- **Real-world relevance**: Mention how you'd occasionally link lab tasks to industry practices (e.g. using AI tools, version control, or debugging strategies).

🗣️ Practice Your Delivery

- Keep your tone enthusiastic but professional.
- Prepare a few anecdotes—like how you helped a struggling student last year or how you debugged a tricky issue in Flying Football.
- Be ready to ask questions too: e.g. "Are there any new tools or teaching methods being introduced this year that I should be aware of?"

Would you like help drafting a short pitch or practicing answers to likely questions? I can roleplay Paul if you want to rehearse.

You

(Now Wednesday, Sep 10)
Can you give me some example answers and phrases I can say (with context)

Copilot

Absolutely, Hasan! Here are tailored example phrases and answers you can use during your Teams call with Paul, organized by the key areas he asked you to reflect on. These are designed to sound natural, confident, and grounded in your experience:

💬 1. *Why You'd Like to Do the Role*

Context: Paul wants to understand your motivation. You've already demonstrated enthusiasm in your email—now you can expand on it.
Example phrases:

- "I really enjoyed being a demonstrator last year—it was one of the most rewarding parts of my university experience. I found that I genuinely looked forward to the labs each week."
- "These modules in particular—Programming and AI—stood out to me both academically and personally. They sparked my interest in software development and AI, which I've continued to explore through projects and internships."
- "I see this role as a chance to give back and help first-years build confidence in areas that can feel intimidating at first."

🧠 2. *What You Could Bring to the Role*

Context: This is your chance to highlight your skills and experience from your CV and email.
Example phrases:

- "I think my technical background gives me a strong foundation to support students. For example, I built an AI-powered document extraction app during my internship at BCFT, which helped me understand how to apply classroom concepts in real-world settings."
- "I've also worked on group projects where I led development and supported teammates with debugging and problem-solving—skills that translate well to a lab environment."
- "Beyond the technical side, I've developed strong communication skills through presenting demos and outreach work, which helps me explain concepts clearly and patiently."

🛠️ 3. *Your Approach in the Labs*

Context: Paul wants to know how you'd interact with students and support their learning.
Example phrases:

- "I'd aim to create a supportive and approachable atmosphere. I remember how helpful it was when demonstrators made it easy to ask questions without feeling judged."
- "My approach would be to guide students through their thinking rather than give them direct answers—helping them build problem-solving skills and confidence."
- "If students are struggling, I'd try to relate the task to something more intuitive or real-world. For example, when explaining loops, I might use examples like daily routines or simple automation tasks."

🙋 4. *Optional Questions You Could Ask Paul*

Context: Asking thoughtful questions shows initiative and engagement.
Example phrases:

- "Are there any changes to the lab format or tools being used this year that I should be aware of?"
- "Is there anything specific you're looking for in demonstrators this year—like more involvement in marking or feedback?"
- "Would there be opportunities to support students outside of lab hours, like drop-in sessions or forums?"

Would you like me to help you rehearse answers in a mock Q&A format next? I can play Paul and ask you questions so you can practice your delivery.

You

The interview is today, what are some final tips and tricks you could give me?

Copilot

You're nearly there, Hasan! Here's a final prep kit to help you walk into that Teams call feeling sharp, confident, and ready to impress:

☑ **1. Set the Scene**

- **Tech check**: Make sure your camera, mic, and internet are solid. Have your CV open in case you need to reference it.
- **Environment**: Quiet space, neutral background, good lighting. Dress smart-casual—clean and professional, but approachable.

🧠 **2. Know Your Talking Points**

Have these three answers polished and ready:

- **Why this role?** → "I genuinely enjoy helping students grow. These modules shaped my own academic journey, and I want to help others feel confident in them too."
- **What do you bring?** → "I've got hands-on experience with AI and programming, plus a year of demonstrator experience. I know how to support students without spoon-feeding."
- **Your lab approach?** → "I'd focus on creating a friendly space where students feel safe asking questions. I guide them through their thinking so they build real problem-solving skills."

🗣 **3. Speak with Warmth and Clarity**

- Smile when you talk—it comes through in your voice.
- Keep answers concise but personal. Use phrases like:
  - "From my experience last year…"
  - "One thing I've found really effective is…"
  - "I'd love to bring that same energy to this year's cohort."

💡 **4. Ask One Smart Question**

This shows you're engaged and thinking ahead:

- "Are there any new tools or teaching approaches being introduced this year?"
- "Is there scope for demonstrators to support students outside of lab hours?"

🧘 **5. Mindset Tricks**

- **Breathe**: Before the call, take 3 deep breaths to calm your nerves.
- **Visualize**: Picture the call going smoothly—Paul nodding, smiling, saying "Great point."
- **Reframe**: This isn't a test—it's a conversation with someone who already sees potential in you.

You've got the experience, the enthusiasm, and the clarity. Now it's just about showing it with confidence. Want a quick pep talk or mock Q&A before you jump in? I'm here for it.

Conversation by Fifa Utuber with Copilot on Wednesday, Sep 10 2025